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DJIA 51671.03 ▲ 468.77 0.92% NASDAQ 26683.94 ▲ 3.1% STOXX 600 634.44 ▲ 0.2% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 4/32, yield 4.468% OIL \$80.75 ▼ \$4.13 GOLD \$4,328.00 ▲ \$113.00 EURO \$1.1591 YEN 160.34

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Oil prices fell**, bonds rallied and the Dow industrials closed at a record 51671.03 after Trump announced a deal to end the war with Iran and re-open the Strait of Hormuz. **A1**
- ◆ **The Justice Department's** senior leadership closed an investigation of Paramount Skydance's bid for Warner Bros. Discovery before career staffers who were concerned about the acquisition had an opportunity to object. **A1**
- ◆ **Fox Corp. is acquiring** Roku in a deal valued at around \$25 billion, making a major bet on the future of ad-supported streaming. **B1**
- ◆ **Renault and Thales** made a prototype of a tactical vehicle for military land forces as automakers and defense suppliers gear up to play a larger role in arms production. **B3**
- ◆ **General Motors is** in talks with Lockheed Martin about making parts for the defense contractor's weapons. **B1**
- ◆ **A consumer demanded** that Anthropic reimburse customers of its most-expensive AI subscription plans, alleging in a lawsuit that the company oversold the usage allowances it offered. **B1**
- ◆ **Talks between Anthropic** and the Trump administration continued without a deal to resolve the security concerns that pushed the White House to restrict access to the AI company's latest model. **A4**
- ◆ **A federal judge in** California dismissed a lawsuit from Elon Musk's xAI that accused OpenAI of trying to steal trade secrets. **B1**
- ◆ **France-based Schneider** Electric said it would work with Taiwan's Foxconn to develop AI data centers. **B4**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Trump said the** Strait of Hormuz would be fully open on Friday, the day the U.S. and Iran plan to conclude a peace deal in Switzerland that ends the four-month war and kick-starts nuclear negotiations. **A8**
- ◆ **The agreement raised** alarm in Israel, where officials are wrestling with the consequences of easing the pressure on Tehran and the risks of opening a rift with the U.S. **A8**
- ◆ **California Gov. Gavin** Newsom said the Justice Department is investigating him and his wife, accusing Trump of pushing the probe to punish a political enemy. **A3**
- ◆ **Russian airstrikes** killed at least 11 people in Ukraine and damaged cultural sites across the country, including one of the holiest sites in Eastern Orthodoxy. **A10**
- ◆ **Eight crew members** were believed dead after a B-52 bomber crashed shortly after takeoff at Edwards Air Force Base in California. **A2**
- ◆ **The U.K. plans** to force leading social-media companies to restrict access to their sites for children under 16. **A10**
- ◆ **Authorities reported** one of the highest daily increases in Ebola cases in a month-old outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo. **A11**
- ◆ **Democrats in** Congress sent letters to the National Science Foundation asking it to reverse its plan to dismantle an ocean-monitoring network. **A2**
- ◆ **The eldest son of** Norway's Crown Princess Mette-Marit was sentenced to four years in prison after being convicted of rape. **A11**

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Trump Starts Visit to a Wary Europe



ARM'S LENGTH: French President Emmanuel Macron greets President Trump on Monday in Évian-les-Bains as the G-7 summit opens. Europe's leaders are in a less trusting mood with the U.S. **A8**

Oil Prices Fall, Stocks Climb On Iran Deal

U.S. indexes cap best three-session stretch in more than a year; Nasdaq rises 3.1%

By Heather Gillers

Investors just shook loose one of the biggest drags on market sentiment since late February. Oil prices fell, bonds rallied and the Dow Jones Industrial Average closed at a record on Monday after President Trump announced a deal to end the war with Iran and re-open the Strait of Hormuz, the world's most vital artery for energy shipments. The latest Middle East developments added to the ledger of optimistic news and capped the market's best three-session stretch since the May 2025 tariff de-escalation with China. Wednesday's readout on lower inflation,

followed by Friday's blockbuster stock debut by Elon Musk's SpaceX, had left investors feeling good about stocks heading into the weekend. "It's like a three-legged stool supporting the market today," said Shannon Saccoccia, chief investment officer of wealth at Neuberger Berman. Chip stocks soared, with the PHLX Semiconductor Index gaining 5.5%. Europe finally clawed back its wartime stock losses, with the pan-continental Stoxx Europe 600 closing at a record. Shares of United Airlines rose 3.9% to close at a record. Higher oil prices had put pressure on airlines, helping push Spirit Airlines into bankruptcy. The Dow industrials gained

- ◆ **Israel is left scrambling for answers**..... **A8**
- ◆ **Iran and U.S. both claim** victories in deal..... **A8**

Warsh Wants the Fed to Stop Talking So Much

By Nick Timiraos

Kevin Warsh boiled down his advice for the Federal Reserve before an audience of investors last year. "Stop talking so much," he said. "More thinking, less talking." For more than a decade, Warsh has argued that the Fed should say less. How much a central bank reveals about its thinking shapes mortgage rates, markets and the cost of borrowing for everyone. Wall Street will parse Wednesday's meeting, his first as Fed chairman, for any sign of where he'll take it.

As a Fed governor through the 2008-09 crisis, Warsh had a front-row seat watching Ben Bernanke pioneer two of the central bank's biggest innovations this century—a far larger holding of bonds and a more systematic practice of explaining its moves. Bernanke was extending a shift Alan Greenspan began in the 1990s, when the Fed first started announcing its rate decisions and signaling where they might head. Warsh quit in 2011 after souring on the bond buying and has spent the years since arguing the Fed took both innovations too far. Now that he's in

charge, the question is whether he proceeds as a revolutionary, a diplomat or both. Whatever Warsh hoped to do on interest rates will have to wait. Inflation is running hot after the war in Iran sent up energy prices. The conversation at the Fed has shifted toward hikes, not cuts. It would be a near-impossible setup for a new chairman to override, even if he wished to. That leaves two ambitious projects, which are moving at different speeds. Shrinking the bondholdings could take years, and communications is where he can move first. Being fenced

in on rates, with no fight to wage there, frees him to spend his energy on it. In Warsh's view, the central bank has buried itself in its own communication. It produces forecasts that markets fixate on and that box the committee in. Officials give speeches or interviews on every side of every question. Warsh wants the Fed to say less and let markets do more of the work. With no action expected on rates on Wednesday, the attention will be on him: Will he submit a forecast for rate projections he disdains? How much



Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh

INSIDE



WORLD NEWS
Russia strikes cultural sites in Ukraine, including a 1,000-year-old cathedral. **A10**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
The party game where Silicon Valley's elite pretend to kill each other. **B1**

An African Nation's Soccer Hero: The Fan Who Can Stop Goals

Congolese man's motionless presence is seen as critical to the team's success

By Nicholas Bariyo

KAMPALA, Uganda—Michel Kuka Mboladinga is on a mission so critical that the president of the Democratic Republic of Congo personally intervened so he could carry it out on his behalf. The task: stop the country's World Cup opponents from scoring. Mboladinga is the Congolese national team's most famous fan, known for his practice of holding a statue-like pose and steely gaze throughout entire games. The ritual is a tribute to his country's founding prime minister, Patrice Lumumba, who was assassinated in a Belgian-led plot in 1961.

Lumumba Vea, Mboladinga's nickname, means Lumumba Lives. Known for his snappy suits and his resemblance to the slain leader, Mboladinga stays frozen to give his side the strength to block shots and to win battles on the pitch. "I stand motionless because I believe it gives the team emotional stamina," he said in a phone interview last week. "Just as Lumumba sacrificed his life for our country, mine is a small price to pay because of how deeply I care about this team." His online fame peaked during the 2025 Africa Cup of Nations. Please turn to page A13



Long shot

DOJ Cleared Paramount Deal As Staffers Looked to Fight It

WASHINGTON—The Justice Department's senior leadership closed an investigation of Paramount Skydance's bid for Warner Bros. Discovery before career staffers who were concerned about the acquisition had an opportunity to object, according to people familiar with the matter.

By Dave Michaels, Dana Mattioli, Sadie Gurman and Jessica Toonkel

A team of career lawyers who had spent months scrutinizing the deal were leaning toward recommending a lawsuit challenging it on the grounds that the combination of the owners of two movie studios would be anticompetitive and violate antitrust law, the people said.

The staff investigators hadn't yet made a final recommendation—a typical step in the deal-review process—and were told Friday that the department would close the investigation, effectively clearing the deal at the federal level, some of the people said. The Justice Department's senior leaders believed that Paramount Chief Executive Officer David Ellison, son of Trump ally Larry Ellison, persuasively addressed many of the staff's questions about the deal during a two-hour interview last month, according to people familiar with their thinking.

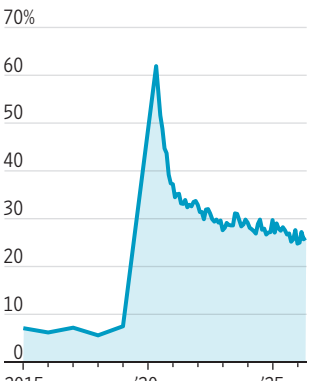
Among staffers' questions was how the combined company could meet its commitment to make 30 theatrical releases a year, given its increased debt load. The senior leaders allowed the inquiries but believed Paramount's debt wasn't a reason to challenge the merger, the people familiar with their thinking said. No one on the investigative team spoke up to leadership. Please turn to page A2

Remote Work Appears Here to Stay, Even Over Some Bosses' Objections

By Justin Lahart

Work from home is hardly over. In fact, it's probably here to stay. The past couple of years have seen a drumbeat of big companies announcing, to great fanfare, that they were requiring employees to spend more time in the office. Home Depot, Target, Microsoft, 3M, Intel—the list goes on and on. "I come in, and—where is everybody else?" complained JPMorgan Chase Chief Executive Jamie Dimon in a recording that leaked to Barron's in early 2025. The bank required its employees to come back to the office five days a week starting in March last year. But across the broader economy, the evidence suggests that the return to the office has stalled out. An average of 26% of paid,

Percentage of paid full days worked from home



Note: Data through 2019 based on Labor Department statistics. Source: Barrero, Bloom, Davis

and Steven Davis. That is down, but not by much, from the 27% registered two years earlier. It was about 30% in 2022, when companies were transitioning away from the pandemic. But in 2019, before the pandemic struck, Labor Department figures show that about 7% of days were worked from home. "The data does seem at odds with the Jamie Dimon story of the world, where remote work is dead," said Emma Harrington, an economist at the University of Virginia who studies remote work. Instead, remote-work rates appear to have reached a new equilibrium, with far more people working from home at least part of the time than before the pandemic. Other data tell a similar story. Kastle Systems, a security company, said that remote work has become a permanent fixture. Please turn to page A2